PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #18 · SOCIAL ISOLATION · CLOSENESS ISN'T IMPORTANT

"Close relationships aren't important to me."

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Do you feel that close relationships just are not important to you? Do you see little reason to be intimate with anyone? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing how God made us for connection, and to find the joy that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When earlier closeness brought pain, demands, or disappointment, a person may decide that intimacy is not worth the cost. Others genuinely feel little pull toward people, and over time they conclude that relationships do not matter. Family and friends may notice that the person has become emotionally distant, even in marriage, and that they seem unmoved by what once mattered.

How the belief can keep itself going

Not needing closeness feels tidy and low-maintenance. But the people around us, including spouses and children, may feel the distance, and the person misses what only relationships can give. Because the belief spares the person from the risk of closeness, it rarely gets tested.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is clear that relationship is part of how God made us. "It is not good for the man to be alone." "Love the Lord your God with all your heart... The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.'" Jesus said, "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." "A friend loves at all times." We were made to give and receive love. Even when closeness is hard, it matters to God, and learning to be close can be a gift for us and those who love us.

> *"The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'" (Genesis 2:18)*

Also see

> "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another." (John 13:35)

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity." (Proverbs 17:17)

> "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'" (1 Corinthians 12:21)

> "We love because He first loved us." (1 John 4:19)

Common self-statements

- Intimacy is not important to me.
- I do not need anyone close.
- Relationships are not worth the effort.
- I am fine without a close connection.
- I am simply not a relational person.
- Others make too much of closeness.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “I find closeness hard” into “closeness is unimportant.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing relationships as either intense or unnecessary.
- Mislabeling: Calling a fear of being hurt “not needing anyone.”
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring warm moments with others.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling little and concluding that nothing matters.
- Selective attention: Counting the costs of closeness and overlooking the gifts.

Challenging questions

- Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- What did closeness cost me in the past?
- What do the people who love me say they miss?
- What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?
- If a friend told me close relationships do not matter to them, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Close relationships matter to God, and they matter to the people who love me. If closeness has been painful or unnatural, I can move toward it slowly, in ways that fit me. I was made to love and be loved.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me for relationship, even when it feels unnatural. Soften my heart, show me the value of closeness, and help me love and be loved at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Loneliness
- Love for Others
- Marriage

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

If We Are the Body
Casting Crowns

The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

The God Who Stays
Matthew West

God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

I Am Not Alone
Kari Jobe

God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus
Keith and Kristyn Getty

This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this appear in Beck and Freeman's discussion of what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder (Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders, 1990, pp. 359–363), where intimate relations are held to be unimportant. In clinical experience, a spouse may be the one who first notices the detachment. A preference for limited social contact is not itself a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that closeness has no value, especially when it costs the person support or strains a marriage. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What small act of connection could I offer today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Close relationships aren't important to me."

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Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Close relationships aren't important to me." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "Close relationships aren't important to me."

- ☐ Have close relationships always felt unimportant, or did something change?
- ☐ What did closeness cost me in the past?
- ☐ What do the people who love me say they miss?
- ☐ What might I be missing by not letting anyone close?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about how God made us?
- ☐ Is there a kind of closeness that feels manageable, such as shared activities or conversation?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ I was made for relationship.
- ☐ Love matters to God, and it matters to those who love me.
- ☐ Closeness can start small.
- ☐ I can move toward people at my own pace.
- ☐ I can give love, even if I do not feel it strongly.
- ☐ Connection can add to my life.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Genesis 2:18
  "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'"
- ☐ John 13:35
  "By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another."
- ☐ Proverbs 17:17
  "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:21
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'"

☐ 1 John 4:19
“We love because He first loved us.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

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5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone you love what they enjoy doing together, and do it for a short time.
- ☐ Tell one person something you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Share a meal with someone and focus on listening.
- ☐ Ask your spouse or a close family member how you could be more present, and listen without defending.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing what you enjoy about being with a particular person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to teach you the value of love.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being made for connection and love.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Close relationships aren't important to me.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I was made for relationship. Closeness matters to God and to those who love me, and I can grow in it at my own pace.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Genesis 2:18

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me for relationship. Teach me to love and receive love at a pace I can manage. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.